An idea for new project for the Arab Astronomers

Dr. Randa Asa'd
(American University of Sharjah)

Background..

- My research field is integrated spectra of stellar clusters (ADS). I spend the summer with my collaborators at Harvard Smithsonian Center for Astrophysics.

- There, I met Dr. Stella Kafka, director of the American Association of Variable Star Observers (AAVASO).

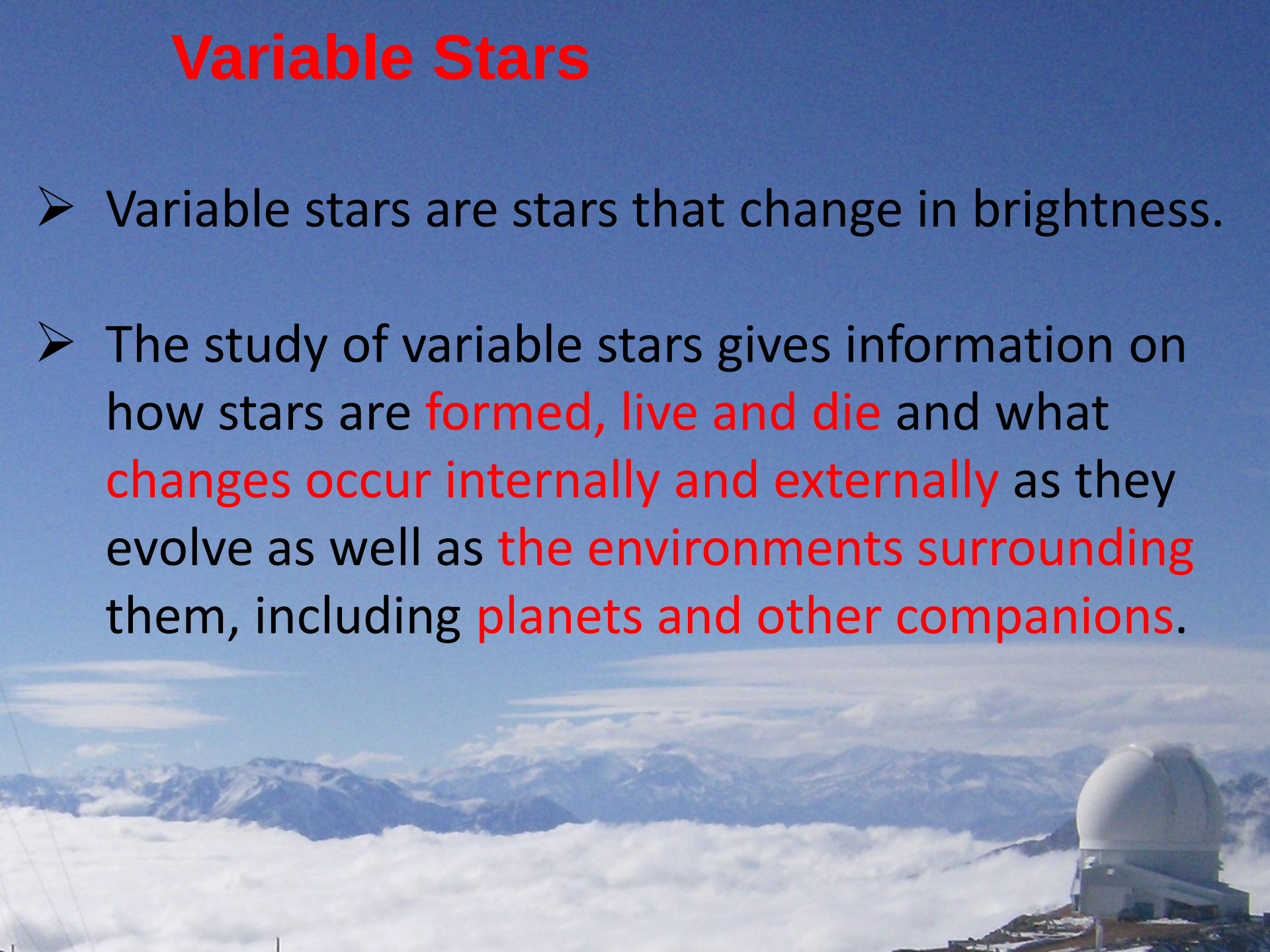
- She showed the map of AAVSO observers and members..


AAVSO Members and Observers
Search
Map
Iceland
Sweden
Russia
Kazakhstan
Mongolia
China
North Atlantic Ocean
Mexico
Algeria
Libya
Egypt
Iraq
Iran
Afghanistan
Pakistan
India
Saudi Arabia
Thailand
Mali
Niger
Sudan
Chad
Nigeria
Ethiopia
Venezuela
Colombia
Kenya
DR Congo
Tanzania
Indonesia
Peru
Brazil
Angola
Namibia
Madagascar
Indian Ocean
South Atlantic Ocean
South Africa
Chile
Google
2000 km
Terms of Use

Variable Stars

- Variable stars are stars that change in brightness.

- The study of variable stars gives information on how stars are formed, live and die and what changes occur internally and externally as they evolve as well as the environments surrounding them, including planets and other companions.



Can we contribute to changing this map?

- The unaided eye is sufficient for bright stars, while for fainter stars you a telescope is needed.

- Observers send their data to Headquarter, where they are checked processed and added to the AAVSO international Database.

- Members and observers have a unique opportunity to present and exchange ideas at the AAVSO meetings and publish in peer-review journals.

Planning ahead:

- We are working on translating the observer manual to Arabic.
- In my astrophysics course next semester this will be the research project for my students.
- We have a large number of observers in the different countries. I propose starting a group in the Arab countries for this observing program.